

SCORE FUNDRAISING TOOLKIT

A COLLABORATION OF THE SCORE ASSOCIATION AND THE SCORE FOUNDATION

Thank you for everything you do to support SCORE's mission of fostering vibrant small business communities through mentoring and education. We are thrilled to present this Fundraising Toolkit, created in collaboration with the SCORE Association, including collective best practices from chapters that have been successful in their own fundraising efforts.

The toolkit offers tips on fundraising, and simple, practical steps your chapter can implement now to begin attracting new or additional funding in support of local programs and services provided by your chapter. It is an evolving resource with a goal of increased funding for the entire organization. We will continue to add new content to the toolkit as we receive input from you, our dedicated volunteers.

The Table of Contents is designed to help you easily navigate through the many resources available. Whether you are a first-time fundraiser or an experienced one, this toolkit has something for you. Of course, there is no single right way to raise money, so we have incorporated several strategies and examples from the field.

Fundraising can be easy, simple, and fun. It is also as much an art as it is a science, and it is all about relationship building. If you can talk to people, which we suspect you can if you signed up to be a mentor, then you can raise money!

With a little planning and storytelling, you too can be a successful fundraiser! Our hope is that this toolkit will help guide you through your fundraising journey. Good luck!

With much gratitude,

Liz Sara, President, The SCORE Foundation

07/15/22

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Section 1: Toolkit Overview

This toolkit offers some simple, practical steps that your chapter can implement now to begin attracting new or additional resources to the programs and services of your SCORE chapter.

Sections include information on:

- relationship building with your supporters
- setting fundraising goals
- effective ways of asking for financial support
- sponsorships
- grant writing
- annual fundraising programs (e.g., tribute programs, member appeals)
- thanking and recognizing your donors.
- SCORE national resources to help your local efforts

Some of the samples we have included in [Section 3: Tools and Resource Directory](#) are:

- "solicitation" letters/emails
- a sample grant outline/application
- sponsorship pricing structures
- presentation slide decks
- flyers and brochures

Please review the entire [Section 3: Tools and Resource Directory](#) for useful documents you can customize, refer to or recreate for your chapter's fundraising efforts.

Section 2: Case for Support

You are making a difference. You are helping small business owners thrive and therefore impacting your local economy in a very positive way. You are also part of a national team impacting thousands of communities throughout the country.

While the SBA funding supports the basic infrastructure necessary to keep 240 chapters open, it often takes much more money to keep the chapters running effectively and to implement community-specific initiatives. Therefore, it is important to raise additional funding in support of your local efforts. Developing your case for support is essential to engage potential donors.

Whether funding comes from individuals, corporations, or banks investing community reinvestment dollars, your donors want to feel like part of something impactful. While you may need funding to support your operations, help potential donors understand the impact their funding will have on the local small business

community. Create fundraising opportunities beyond operational support. Highlight the programs and services you are offering to help small businesses in your community thrive.

Build a case that demonstrates how SCORE helps strengthen and improve the community by:

- improving the local economy by helping start small businesses and create jobs
- educating small businesses and entrepreneurs
- providing free educational service that allows entrepreneurs and their businesses to grow and get stronger
- provides resources to help existing businesses get stronger to become more stable parts of the community

To help strengthen your case for support, you can find your chapter's impact and demographic data in various ways. Refer to the [Section 5: Obtaining Data to get Funding](#).

Fundraising Fundamentals by BoardSource

- Organizations are not entitled to support; they must earn it.
- Successful fundraising is not magic.
- Fundraising is really about building relationships.
- You do not raise money by begging for it.
- People will not give money if they aren't asked.
- You don't decide today to raise money, and then ask for it tomorrow.
- Treat prospects and donors as you would customers in a business.

General Fundraising Statistics

- Corporations gave over \$20 billion to nonprofit organizations last year.
- The top 10 most generous corporations donate over \$2 billion annually to nonprofits, much of it through employee matching gift programs.
- 40% of Fortune 500 companies offer volunteer grant programs.

Overall fundraising statistics show that nonprofits of all sizes routinely leave a lot of potential revenue on the table. Philanthropic giving continues to grow, but organizations should be prepared to pursue new opportunities as they emerge. Demographic changes, growth in corporate giving trends, and the dominance of mobile web browsing must all be considered when developing updated fundraising strategies in the coming years.

To view a full overview of fundraising statistics across the various methods of funding, please [click here](#).

Section 3: Tools and Resource Directory

Customizable Documents

Document Title	Description	Link to Download
About SCORE	A PowerPoint presentation that gives a general overview of the organization, graphics, and statistics. This presentation can be customized to your chapter and used for potential donors.	Click to Download
About SCORE Foundation	A PowerPoint presentation that gives a general overview of SCORE and The SCORE Foundation. This presentation can be used for potential donors and the last slide can be customized with chapter contacts.	Click to Download
Sales Deck Presentation	A PowerPoint sales deck that includes an overview of SCORE, customizable slides to highlight initiatives that can be proposed to potential donors. You can pick and choose which opportunities you wish to present to the potential donor.	Click to Download
Partnership Agreement for SCORE Association	Use this partner agreement template if there are local restrictions to the funding. Please note: Your partnership agreements need to be reviewed prior to signatures by the VP of Finance by emailing agreement to accounting@score.org .	Click to Download
Sponsorship Agreement for SCORE Foundation	A Word document that you can complete to create a formal agreement between the chapter and the partner. Please note: Your sponsorship agreements need to be reviewed prior to signatures by the VP of Finance by emailing agreement to accounting@score.org .	Click to Download
Grant Application/Outline	Template of responses to frequently asked questions in grant applications.	Click to Download
Donor Invoice for SCORE Association	A Word document that you can complete to create an invoice to be sent to the donor to collect funds for the Association.	Click to Download
Donor Invoice for SCORE Foundation	A Word document that you can complete to create an invoice to be sent to the donor to collect funds for the Foundation.	Click to Download
Sponsorship Recap Report	A Word document that you can use as a guide in developing a recap report for your donors. This will help with renewing donors the following year.	Click to Download

Form 15 Acknowledgment Gift to SCORE	Template form that must be completed and shared with all SCORE Association donors. This should accompany a personalized thank you email to the donor. You must keep a copy of the Form 15 for your records.	Click to Download
Thank You Letter	A Word document that you can customize to recognize and thank your donors.	Click to Download
Solicitation Email	A Word document that you can customize to email potential donors.	Click to Download
Being a Partner Pays Off Flyer	An editable PDF to showcase how “Being a Partner Pays Off”	Click to Download
Become a Partner Flyer	An editable PDF to recruit partners	Click to Download
Partner Brochure	An editable 4-page PDF to support your “Ask”	Click to Download

Helpful Resources on SCORE Support Center

Resource	Description	Link to View
2021 National Impact Handout	2-page PDF with overview of SCORE National Impact	Click here to view
Current Partner Initiatives	List of all current SCORE Foundation partners, aka national partners. This list details each partner program and opportunities for local chapters, if applicable.	Click here to view
Partner Workshop Grants	List of all current grant opportunities from our national partners.	Click here to view
Guide: Restricted vs Unrestricted Funds	A PDF of examples of sources of restricted and unrestricted revenue. As well as examples of allowable vs unallowable expenditures.	Click here to view
SCORE Foundation Contribution Instructions for Donors	Instructions for all forms of payment to the SCORE Foundation.	Click here to view
Chapter Funds in the Foundation	Overview of the benefits of holding unrestricted funds in the Foundation, how to set up account and access chapter funds.	Click here to view
ACH Direct Deposit Information for SCORE Association	Detailed account information for Direct Deposit for chapter accounts.	Click here to view
BoA Direct Deposit Information for SCORE Foundation	Detailed account information for Direct Deposit for chapter Foundation accounts.	Click here to view

GuideStar Ratings for SCORE Association	GuideStar is a service that provides ratings on 2.5 million US based non-profits. These ratings have become a trusted source of legitimacy of non-profit organizations. A chapter can reference SCORE's gold star rating while soliciting potential donors to prove good stewardship of dollars raised.	Click here to view
GuideStar Ratings for SCORE Foundation	GuideStar is a service that provides ratings on 2.5 million US based non-profits. These ratings have become a trusted source of legitimacy of non-profit organizations. A chapter can reference SCORE Foundation's gold star rating while soliciting potential donors to prove good stewardship of dollars raised.	Click here to view

Sample Documents from SCORE Chapters

Resource	Description	Link to View
Grant Solicitation Email	An example email from SCORE Miami-Dade requesting support from local community organizations.	Click to view
Sponsorship Levels	SCORE Orange County's sponsorship program, organized by sponsorship level and dollar amounts	Click to view
Workshop & Webinar Sponsorship Pricing	SCORE Orange County's workshop and webinar sponsorship pricing structure	Click to view
Conference Sponsorship Pricing	SCORE Orange County's annual conference sponsorship pricing structure	Click to view
What is SCORE I Pager	A one-page document developed by SCORE Orange County providing a simple overview of the organization.	Click to view
Sponsorship Slide Deck	SCORE Miami-Dade's sponsorship slide deck outlining their local chapter statistics, programs and opportunities to partner.	Click to view
Small Business Awards Sponsorship Levels	SCORE Houston's sponsorship pricing structure for their annual small business awards luncheon event.	Click to view
SBA Sponsorship Impact Flyer	A one-page document developed by SCORE Houston that recaps the impact of sponsor contributions.	Click to view
Bank Strategy	SCORE Savannah's Treasurer provides a detailed strategy in how to obtain funds from your local banks.	Click to view

Supporting Documents for Grant Applications: SCORE Association

Document Title	Description	Link to Download
Chapter W-9	This links the chapter's name to Service Corps of Retired Executives which is on the 990 and IRS Affirmation Letter.	Click here to view
IRS Tax Return Form 990 (Association)		Click here to view
IRS Affirmation Letter for SCORE Association	SCORE's 501c3 confirmation and letter of proof.	Click here to view
Audited Financial Statements for SCORE Association	These financial statements are commonly requested documents for grant applications.	Click here to view
Board of Directors for SCORE Association	Many grant applications request a list of current board members.	Click here to view
Articles of Incorporation for SCORE Association	SCORE's first Articles from 1975.	Click here to view
Bylaws for SCORE Association	As of December 2020.	Click here to view
General Chapter Liability	Policy overviewing general coverage for chapters.	Click here to view
SAM.gov Certification		Click here to view

Supporting Documents for Grant Applications: SCORE Foundation

Document Title	Description	Link to Download
Chapter W-9	This links the chapter's name to Service Corps of Retired Executives which is on the 990 and IRS Affirmation Letter.	Click here to view
IRS Tax Return Form 990 (Foundation)		Click here to view
IRS Affirmation Letter for SCORE Foundation	SCORE Foundation's 501c3 confirmation and letter of proof.	Click here to view
Audited Financial Statements for SCORE Foundation	These financial statements are commonly requested documents for grant applications.	Click here to view
Board of Directors for SCORE Foundation	Many grant applications request a list of current board members.	Click here to view

Boilerplate Language About SCORE

Feel free to copy and paste any of the language below into your grant applications or any communications with potential sponsors.

What is SCORE?

SCORE is America's small business resource.

- Free, Confidential Business Advice
- One-on-one Mentoring in Person & Online.
- Workshops, Seminars & Events in Your Community.
- Business Tools & Templates at www.score.org.

Small Business...Huge Impact

SCORE was formed in 1964 as a resource partner of the U.S. Small Business Administration whose mission is to help aspiring and existing businesses succeed. Since then, we've helped more than 11 million people in pursuit of their business goals.

SCORE is a uniquely American organization that synthesizes two historic national ideals: entrepreneurial spirit and volunteerism. Since 1964, SCORE has provided expert volunteer mentoring to more than 11 million entrepreneurs and small business owners. As the nation's largest network of volunteer business mentors, SCORE is committed to helping any person succeed in their small business endeavor.

In 2021 SCORE helped...

- Create over 25,084 new businesses
- Create over 71,475 new non-owner jobs
- Create over 96,559 total jobs

More than 350,000 entrepreneurs seek help from SCORE each year through our team of 10,000+ volunteers in 1,500 communities.

About SCORE

Since 1964, SCORE has helped 11 million entrepreneurs start or grow a business. SCORE's 10,000 volunteers provide free mentoring, workshops and educational services to 1,500+ communities nationwide, creating 25,084 new businesses and 71,475 non-owner jobs in 2021 alone. Visit SCORE at www.score.org. Follow @SCOREMentors on [Facebook](#), [Instagram](#), [Twitter](#), and [LinkedIn](#).

Below are some helpful SCORE talking points to incorporate into your conversations or materials:

- SCORE is the nation's largest network of volunteer, expert business mentors and is dedicated to helping small businesses get off the ground, grow and achieve their goals.



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- Since 1964, SCORE has provided education and mentorship to more than 11 million entrepreneurs.
- SCORE mentors are a valuable resource for any current or aspiring entrepreneur.
- SCORE mentors bring years of business experience, many of them successful small business owners themselves. Nearly half of SCORE mentors are still actively working/running their own business.
- Mentors volunteer through SCORE to help other entrepreneurs by sharing their real-world experience and knowledge in running successful small businesses.
- SCORE mentors also provide practical tools and resources to make some owner tasks easier.
- SCORE mentors are experienced in all aspects and stages of business development, whether you're thinking of starting a business or growing your existing company.
- Since SCORE is a nonprofit resource partner of the U.S. Small Business Administration (SBA), our mentoring services are free, regardless of the number of times you visit or meet with a mentor either in-person, by phone or online.
- You can always head to score.org for more information.
- *NOTE to share with reporters* - SCORE no longer stands for anything (as it was formerly referred to as Service Corps of Retired Executives). Nearly half of our volunteers are still actively working, so we shortened our formal name to SCORE.

Section 4: Where Should the Money Go?

When fundraising at the chapter level for SCORE, you must determine what you are fundraising for. The following guide will help make that decision.

The SCORE Foundation was founded 25+ years ago to allow SCORE to raise additional funding to further our mission of fostering vibrant small business communities through mentoring and education. Nationally, all public fundraising comes through the SCORE Foundation including corporate sponsorships and individual donations. Although these funds support SCORE programs and services, funds are not restricted by the same federal guidelines since the Foundation is publicly funded. Our recommendation is that you use the Foundation to raise funds on a local level as well. Below are some of the benefits of doing so.

[Click here to view a simple comparison of restricted vs unrestricted examples.](#)

Benefits of holding unrestricted funds in the Foundation

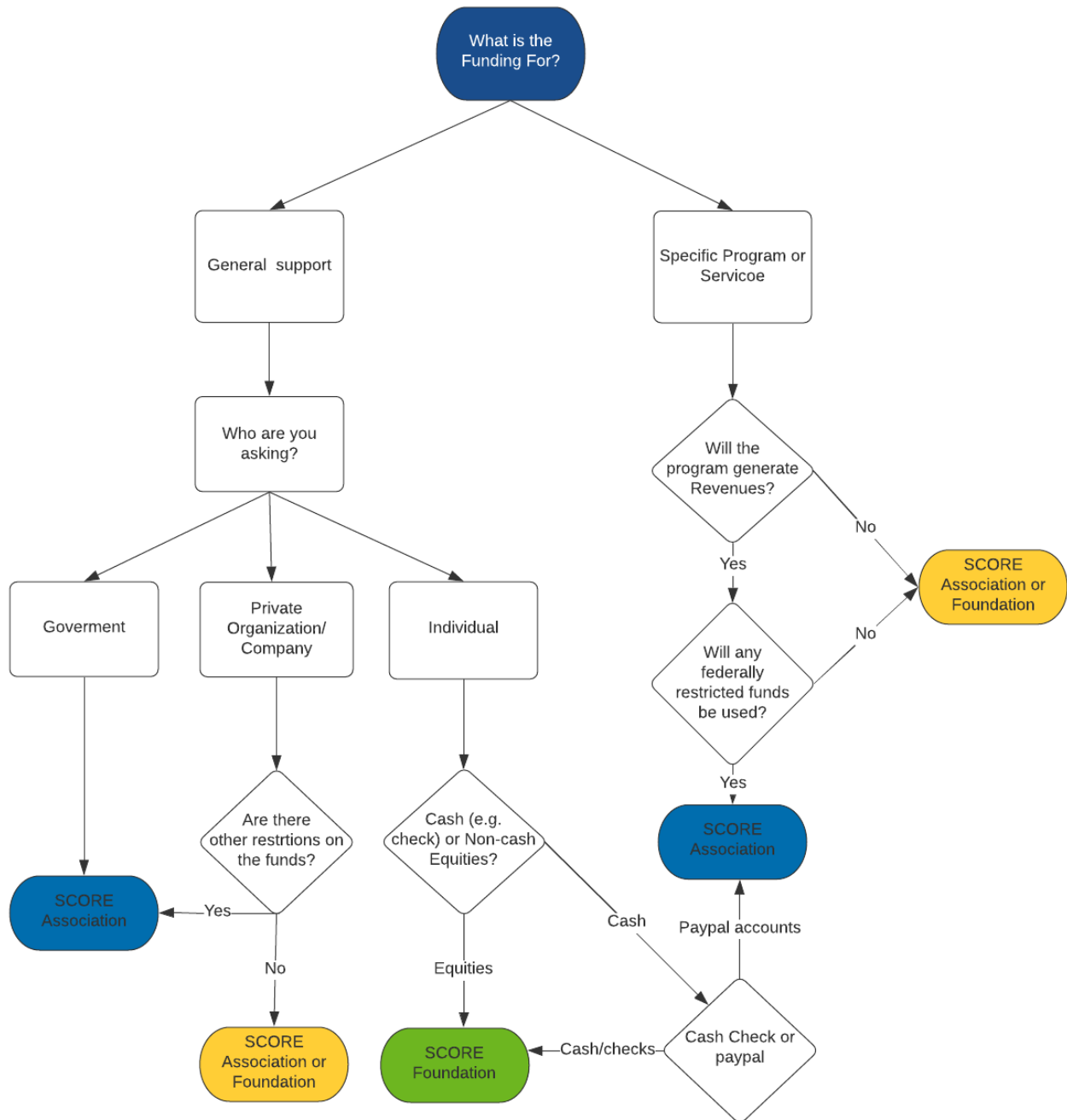
Funds raised under the SCORE Foundation, while still governed by the IRS codes, are not restricted by Federal guidelines. Holding chapter funds in the Foundation allows for:

- The chapter to keep funds segregated from operations.
- Better compliance with government regulations; lower risk of commingling of funds.
- Donors who wish to contribute to a foundation rather than a society.
- The Foundation takes responsible for proper IRS recognition of all donations.



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- Donate stocks, bonds, or other marketable securities.
- The Foundation can invest funds on behalf of the chapter.
- Foundation will process donations eligible for employee matching gifts and dollars for doer programs.



Section 5: Obtaining Data to Get Funding

To help strengthen your case for support, you can find your chapter's impact and demographic data in various ways. See below for the description, uses and how to access each of these assets.

Impact Sheets

Description

A high-level summary sheet of state level impact on the clients in their community over the past fiscal year. The Impact Sheet provides information on the number of new businesses started, the number of total jobs created, and the number of total chapter services (total mentoring sessions provided + total workshop attendees). This information is sourced from the most recent Client Engagement Survey, administered by PricewaterhouseCoopers.

Uses

The Impact Sheet is quite helpful in providing a succinct summary of the value that SCORE provides to communities through their respective states. It also allows chapters to provide definitive numbers on their economic impact and community reach.

How to Access

Impact sheets can be accessed on the Support Center here: <https://help.score.org/hc/en-us/articles/360049412374-Client-Impact-Handouts>. Simply choose the link that corresponds to your chapter number (or state) and download the file.

Chapter Dashboard Performance Report

Description

A snapshot report of a chapter's performance for a given time period broken down into three overall categories: Client & Workshop/Webinar Data, Quality Data, and Volunteer Data.

- The Client & Workshop/Webinar Data section measures services provided by the chapter (mentoring sessions, local workshop/webinars, and total services).
- The Quality Data section measures the quality of the services provided by a chapter (NPS) as well as the quality of their processes for contacting, assigning, and following up with clients.
- The Volunteer Data is a measurement of a chapter's volunteer membership (new and existing) as well as a couple of demographic measurements.

Uses

The Dashboard Performance Report provides comprehensive data on the key performance metrics for a chapter, as well some high-level information on the chapter's volunteer membership. Chapters can also show growth in both services and quality as the Dashboard shows comparison to the previous year.

How to Access

The Dashboard Report is found on the Reports page and is titled [Dashboard Performance Report - SCORE National](#). The report opens at the National level, and volunteers are then able to drill down to their Region, District, Chapter, using the "Go To" link at the top of the report.

Client Information Report

Description

A report containing all relevant information for a chapter's clients including contact and business information, what help they are seeking, and demographic information.

Note - all demographic information is self-reported and dependent on entry by volunteers. Majority of clients don't have full demographic information, so chapters will have to be mindful of the number of responses they need for statistical validity.

Uses

Two most relevant uses in terms of fundraising are collecting demographic information and the type of help clients are seeking. Demographic information is useful when looking to raise money for targeted programs. The information on the type of help needed can be useful when looking to raise money to expand workshop programs or other services.

How to Access

Instructions on how to access full details of the report can be found [here](#).

PwC Client Engagement Survey Results

Description

Each year, SCORE distributes the Client Engagement Survey via PricewaterhouseCoopers. Distributed in October each year, the Client Engagement Survey allows clients to provide feedback on their experience with SCORE over the past fiscal year. Results are then summarized to produce the overall client engagement score at each level (chapter, district, region, National), as well as the stats used on the Impact Sheets. Additionally, client satisfaction and quality of service are measured via the survey.

Uses

The Client Engagement Survey provides a comprehensive look at how clients view the impact that SCORE is having on their lives and businesses. While the Impact Sheets simply measure the number of people helped by SCORE, the Engagement Survey gives insight as to what chapters did that resonated well with clients and

where they can improve. Chapters can use the information to either illustrate their strong standing in the community and how funding would be used **effectively or** show that there are opportunities to do more and reach more people with additional funding.

How to Access

The survey results for each chapter (as well as district and region) are found on the PwC portal: <https://start4.pwc.com/start4/account/login>. Instructions on how to log in as well as training from PwC on how to effectively navigate the portal are found here - [Client Engagement Survey Results](#).

Google Analytics Data

Description

Your prospective partner may want to know how well your website is performing and how much traffic the site sees. To better understand the difference between different Google Analytics terms and data points, [click here](#). If you have any questions regarding Google Analytics, please email marketing@score.org.

Uses

The two most important data points to share would be pageviews and sessions.

Pageviews: A pageview is recorded every time a page is viewed. This includes when a viewer hits refresh, when they open the page in another browser, when the viewer hits the back button. Regardless of whether it has been cached, a pageview is recorded.

Sessions: A session consists of a series of pageviews that a single user makes during a period of activity. The session ends after the user either closes the browser, clears cookies, or is inactive for 30 minutes.

How to Access

To access Google Analytics, visit www.google.com/analytics or email marketing@score.org to grant access.

Social Media Data

Description

If you are going to be running social media campaigns with your prospective partner, they may want to see data on how engaged your clients are with you on social media.

Uses

Social media data points include total views, likes, impressions, etc. On the [Hi-Per Dashboard](#), you can find the following information:

- Facebook Insights: Pageviews, Engaged users, Total likes, Total reach, Total impressions, total posts

- Facebook Ads: any data on any paid Facebook campaigns you may have ran including cost, impressions, clicks, link clicks from actions, etc.
- Google My Business: Search data, total views, clicks to website, etc.
- LinkedIn: Data on followers including the total amount, new followers, etc.
- Google Analytics: Sessions, session duration, pageviews, users, new users, etc. We suggest logging into Google Analytics itself to pull this data.

How to Access

To pull these reports, visit the [Hi-Per dashboard](#). If you do not have a login to the Hi-Per dashboard or have any questions about Social Media data points, please email scoresocial@hi-perlocal.com.

Constant Contact Email Data

Description

Email metrics are important to report on because email is our most effective way to market services.

Uses

The most important data points that a prospective partner may want to see are:

- Open rate: The percentage of total recipients who open a given email. An open is only counted when an invisible tracking image placed within an email by an Email Service Provider is viewed. This tracking image is not considered as having been viewed when an email is seen using an email client with images blocked, which makes open rates a less reliable metric than many realize.
 - If you would like to see this data at a high level across all of your emails, click into the “Reporting” tab in Constant Contact. If you would like to see this data for a specific email, click into that email.
- Click-through rate: The number of times all links in an email were clicked compared to the total list size, represented as a percentage. To determine the click-through rate, divide the number of responses (clicks) by the number of emails opened (multiply this number by 100 to express the result as a percentage).
 - If you would like to see this data at a high level across all of your emails, click into the “Reporting” tab in Constant Contact. If you would like to see this data for a specific email, click into that email.
- Contact Demographics: Data about the size and characteristics of your contact list. You can find these data points by clicking the “Contact” tab in your Constant Contact account. Here you can see how many contacts you have along with your recent growth numbers. You can also see overall engagement data. The engagement data will show you what percentage of your contacts interact with your emails at high, moderate and low levels.

How to Access

Login to your chapter's Constant Contact account and click into the "Reporting" tab. For training on how to run reports in Constant Contact, [click here](#). If you have any questions about email reporting, please contact marketing@score.org.

Section 6: Categories and Sources of Donations

While the SCORE Association receives government/federal dollars through the Small Business Administration grant, the SCORE Foundation raises funding from the private sector, including corporate, foundation, and individual donations. This section explains the sources of funding.

Typically, there are five types of funding sources:

- Individuals
- Corporate/Company
- Foundations
- Government (State and Local)
- SCORE Foundation Corporate Grants

While there are similarities in the solicitation, each constituent should be uniquely approached for its potential as a funding source.

Individuals

Given that this is the largest source of contributions in this country, great attention and effort should be given to developing your fundraising plans with this group as a key component.

Individuals are looking for a chance to become involved, make a difference and change the world. As previously reported, they are the largest constituency providing gifts to the nation's nonprofits. An emotional appeal tug at the heartstrings, which in turn, creates a philanthropic moment. "Emotion is the river on which logic flows," said Robert Sharpe, The National Planned Giving Institute.

Corporate/Company

Whether large or small, companies are looking to make a difference, just like individuals. However, they are interested in relationships that are mutually beneficial to the charity and the business. "Strategic alliances" and "measurable impact" continue as the buzzwords of today's corporate philanthropy. These relationships require time and thoughtful planning. Gone are the days of the "handout." Today's corporations are interested in an alliance that helps them meet their corporation's strategic objectives in the small business marketplace.

Corporations can also give annual and major gifts. Their funding priorities are often found on their website, in an annual report or by calling for guidelines. SCORE is in a unique position to solicit donations because of its relationship with small businesses in America as well as through its many volunteers.

In most cases, at least one of four options are available:



COMPANY	VOLUNTEER GRANT AMOUNT	LEARN MORE
ExxonMobil	\$500 for every 20 hours (Max \$2,000)	ExxonMobil's volunteer grant program
Aetna	\$300 for every 20 hours	Aetna's volunteer grant program
Outerwall (Coinstar / Redbox)	\$15 per hour	Outerwall's volunteer grant program
Verizon	\$750 for every 50 hours (Max \$1,500)	Verizon's volunteer grant program
ConocoPhillips	\$500 for every 20 hours (Max \$1,000)	Conoco Phillips' volunteer grant program
Microsoft	\$25 per hour	Microsoft's volunteer grant program
Dell	\$150 for every 10 hours	Dell's volunteer grant program
RealNetworks	\$15 per hour (Max \$900)	RealNetworks' volunteer grant program
Time Warner and Subsidiaries	\$500	Time Warner's volunteer grant program
Allstate	Either \$500 or \$1,000 depending on role	Allstate's volunteer grant program

- Direct solicitation of the corporate entity in your community – typically through the Marketing/Small Business or Community Relations Departments - whether it is a headquarters in your community or a branch/unit of its national operation.
- Retirees/employees can apply for funds already designated by the corporation for charitable giving to support a retiree/employee interest.
- Matching gifts - Corporations will match a retiree/employee contribution.
- Volunteer Grants - Are also known as “Dollars for Doers” programs, and through these programs, employers offer monetary grants to the organizations that their employees regularly volunteer for. It is the ideal way to combine fundraising, volunteerism, and corporate giving. Note: Please inform the accounting team if someone from your chapter is submitting hours for employee volunteerism programs so we can designate the appropriate funds to your chapter.

Foundations

The causes that foundations fund are as many and varied as the number of foundations in the United States. Most give one-time or multi-year gifts upon acceptance of a grant proposal. As a rule, even small foundations have specific guidelines for submitting proposals that are usually available upon request.

Funding priorities are usually based upon the wishes of the person(s) who established the foundation initially. In some cases, the principals are ultimately involved in grant-making decisions while, in others, a professional staff or designated review board determines the annual distribution of funds. They are usually most interested in demonstrating "thought leadership" in a particular area.

Fundamentally, fundraising is a people business. A successful program will evolve from a plan that addresses the concerns and passions of your potential supporters.

Government (State and Local)

Government funding, usually in the form of grants, has a variety of specific projects and funding areas linked to them. All of these funding sources will have specific guidelines and reporting requirements. You should carefully weigh your chapter's ability to manage these types of funding opportunities before venturing into a commitment.

State and local government funding are not unlike fundraising from the other sectors (individuals and corporations) in that success is predicated on the strength and sustainability of the relationships established. The process is similar, and planning for this process is integral.

*Please remember to report all successful grant applications to accounting@score.org. SCORE HQ needs to have copies of the award letter in order to properly report on all of SCORE's awards.

To download a sample grant agreement along with supporting documents for your grant application, go to [Section 3: Tools and Resource Directory](#).

SCORE Foundation Corporate Grants

The SCORE Foundation has opportunities with National Partners for local chapters to leverage. These opportunities are listed and updated on the [support center](#), usually taking place as a workshop opportunity. [Click here to view current opportunities](#). In addition, you can always connect with your District Director or Regional Vice President to discuss potential opportunities for your chapter.

Gift Types Accepted by The SCORE Foundation

Donations come in various ways; the most notable, of course, is cash. However, other types of gifts can build real financial security for a chapter and guarantee a regular income. For any questions about gift types, please contact accounting@score.org.

Cash - usually one-time in the form of cash, check, or credit card payment. If your chapter cannot accept credit cards, The SCORE Foundation can facilitate the gift and transfer 100% of that gift to the chapter.

Stock - (appreciated securities) still are the most economical form of philanthropic gifting. The tax advantages for the donor are significant, and SCORE is the ultimate beneficiary. Once again, The SCORE Foundation can facilitate these gifts and transfer 100% of that gift back to the chapter.

In-Kind - donor gives something of material value to the organization to be used at the recipient's wishes (e.g., computers that can be used by the chapter, printing services, office supplies, etc.)

Planned Gifts – a contribution that is arranged in the present and allocated at a future date, usually through a will or trust.

Endowments – a donation which uses the resulting investment income for a specific purpose, usually in the form for a trust.

Gift Types Accepted by The SCORE Association

Funds that are accepted on behalf of the SCORE Association are limited. Please see [Section 4: Where Should the Money Go?](#) for more information on how to select if you should store keep your raised funds with the SCORE Foundation or Association. For any questions about gift types, please contact accounting@score.org.

Cash - usually one-time in the form of cash, check, or credit card payment. If your chapter cannot accept credit cards, The SCORE Foundation can facilitate the gift and transfer 100% of that gift to the chapter.

In-Kind - donor gives something of material value to the organization to be used at the recipient's wishes (e.g., computers that can be used by the chapter, printing services, office supplies, etc.)

Section 7: Fundraising Methods

Nonprofits utilize several methods to raise money through the private sector, which, as explained in [Section 6: Donor Categories](#), includes corporate, foundation, and individual donations. Each method of fundraising requires special consideration for soliciting donors and defining donor benefits, but no matter the method, ultimately, all donors will look for a defined return on their investment (ROI). This section defines the methods and outlines the unique ROI expectations for each.

For more detailed information about the types for fundraising, here is a great resource:

<https://doublethedonation.com/tips/nonprofit-fundraising/>

Event Sponsorship (Workshops, Webinars, Expos, Symposiums)

The SCORE Foundation and several chapters have been successful in securing sponsorships to support local events, expos, and workshops. Depending on the type of event, money raised might come in different forms, including sponsorship, registration, raffles, and silent auctions. In addition to their fundraising potential, events provide an avenue by which donors and potential donors can interact in person and learn more about the organization. But events can be costly, so it is important to note that nonprofits generally spend half the revenue raised through events on logistical costs to execute it effectively.

Sponsor recognition or ROI can include the following:

- Promotional table at the event
- Logo recognition on event signage
- List of opt-in registrants (name, email and zip)
- Recognition of sponsorship in marketing materials
- Inclusion in promotional campaigns
- Opportunity for a sponsor representative to address the crowd through an educational presentation or welcome speech.

Note: We have included sample sponsor levels in [Section 3: Tools and Resource Directory](#).

Like events, SCORE workshops and webinars can also be sponsored providing similar sponsor benefits on a smaller scale. For example, a sponsoring bank can also provide a subject matter expert for a workshop on financial literacy and can set up a promotional table in the back of the room. The funds raised from these events could be restricted or unrestricted. [Please use this guide for reference.](#)

If your SCORE chapter is looking to host a virtual event (i.e. volunteer recruiting event or local conferences) for fundraising purposes, [click here to see the technical tools that may be of interest](#) to host a virtual event.

Who Should Sponsor?

Businesses and organizations serving small businesses and entrepreneurs are all prospective sources of support. Think about companies that would benefit by marketing products or services to small businesses or organizations interested in investing in their communities. Banks, law firms, insurance companies, office supply stores.

Sponsors DOs and DON'Ts

DO...

- Accept corporate grants and sponsorships
- Recognize the corporate donors
- Offer project specific sponsorships
- Create marketing events which garner brand exposure
- Provide multiple opportunities for each level of your sponsorship
- Follow the [workshop presenter guidelines](#) when a sponsor is also a workshop presenter
- Have your sponsorship agreements reviewed prior to signatures by the VP of Finance by emailing agreement to accounting@score.org.

DO NOT...

- Advertise on behalf of sponsor/partner
- Directly promote a product good or service
- Offer exclusivity
- Solicit clients with products or services on behalf of the sponsor/partner
- Offer exclusive benefits to a single sponsor
- Use leading language in relation to the sponsor
- Link directly to a product landing page (can link to their homepage)

The “DO NOTs” are prohibited by SCORE’s policies and guidelines, and although raising money through the SCORE Foundation does allow more flexibility, we are respectful of [SCORE’s content guidelines](#).

Individual Giving for General Support

Individual giving represents 80% of all nonprofit donations in America. Strategies to secure individual gifts can include small gifts from a large group of donors or large gifts from a small group of donors (major gifts). There

are many ways to raise money from individuals within each of these strategies. Small Gifts can range from \$5 to \$500 and strategies include Online Peer to Peer or Crowd Fundraising, Facebook/Social Media Campaigns, Honorary or Memorial Gifts, Workplace Giving, Dollars for Doers Volunteer Programs and letter writing or email solicitations. Major Gifts generally range from \$500 to \$50,000 depending on the organization and strategies include Direct Program support, Naming Rights/Capital Campaigns, Planned Giving and Stock Donations.

For the purposes of this guide, we are going to focus on online and email campaigns as they are the most cost-effective way to raise money from your key stakeholders and engage your chapter's volunteers with the effort. When you think about your prospects, you have to consider grant compliance. SCORE must be careful about soliciting money from clients as it can be misconstrued as payment for services. We recommend raising funds for your chapter through the SCORE Foundation to be safe. If you have a regular email communication going out to clients, include a call to action in the footer to donate to your chapter button. You can also send an email several times a year, requesting donations to support all the great work you are doing. Include success stories and your chapter's impact numbers. Let donors know the impact their donations will have on the community and include several hyperlinks throughout with a call to action to donate.

The other option is to ask your chapter volunteers to solicit support from their family, friends, and colleagues through an email campaign or an online peer-to-peer fundraising. We have included a sample email you can share with volunteers in [Section 3: Tools and Resource Directory](#). Online peer-to-peer fundraising can be done in the form of Facebook fundraisers or through sites like MightyCause.org. Facebook fundraisers are fairly easy to set up. For more information, click here, <https://www.facebook.com/help/990087377765844>. If you do set up a Facebook fundraiser, this should be done with the SCORE Foundation EIN and the accounting team should be alerted so we can track the donations. In platforms like MightyCause, you can set up a fundraising page for your volunteers to share with their contacts through email or by text. The SCORE Foundation team can assist by sharing existing SCORE fundraising templates on MightyCause.com.

When it comes to soliciting major gifts, this will take more time to build a relationship with the prospective donor. Similar to sponsorship, an individual making a large contribution will likely seek recognition (e.g. name listed on your website or on a wall plaque) and may request that the donation supports a specific program or initiative. Regardless of whether or not they seek recognition, it is extremely important to thank them often and keep your major donors engaged through frequent communications about the great work you are doing (e.g. quarterly newsletter, annual report, annual impact statement).

Planned gifts and stock donations can be made through the SCORE Foundation and designated to your chapter. If you have donors interested in naming SCORE in his/her will, you can contact the SCORE Foundation team for information at info@scorefoundation.org. Remember these are also considered major gifts, so the ongoing communications strategy should be applied here as well.

For more information about planned giving, click here, <https://plannedgiving.com/about-us/what-is-planned-giving/>.

For more information about stock donations, click here, <https://www.fidelitycharitable.org/giving-account/what-you-can-donate/donating-stock-to-charity.html>.

Grants for Direct Program Support

The SCORE Foundation and several chapters have been successful in securing direct program support through grants provided by private and corporate foundations as well as community reinvestment funds from banks. In each of these cases, the ROI for the funder is to demonstrate a positive impact on small business through the program you are proposing.

These applications often ask for SCORE history, general description, mission, operations, and efficacy. [Click here](#) for some standard language we have used for national applications. To research private and corporate funding available in your community, you can register for a free account on the Foundation Center here: <https://fconline.foundationcenter.org/welcome/quick-start>

If you are going to pursue funding from any of these sources, it is important to lay out the following components for every potential grant proposal.

About the Organization:

We have provided a general description of SCORE in [Section 3: Boilerplate Language About SCORE](#), but it is important to tailor your write up, so the proposal aligns with the funding priorities for the foundation or bank.

Statement of Need:

The potential funder will want to know what problem they are helping you solve. Why are you seeking funding? What is the need your program will address? For example, last year, 1 in 3 small businesses were forced to close their doors due to the pandemic shutdowns. The SBA reports that small business owners who receive 3+ hours of mentoring report higher revenues and increased business growth.

Program Description:

This should be a thorough explanation of the program the grant would support. For example, include a description of our mentoring program and educational workshops focused on helping small business owners adapt to the pandemic.

Measurement of Success:

Potential funders will look to you to define success for this program. The goal of this section is to define a measurement that is impactful and attainable. For example, we know in 2020, SCORE mentors helped 82% of our in-business clients remain in business, according to the national impact data. So, it is realistic to project the number of small businesses you plan to reach and aim to help 75% of your clients remain in business.

Securing Funds from Banks

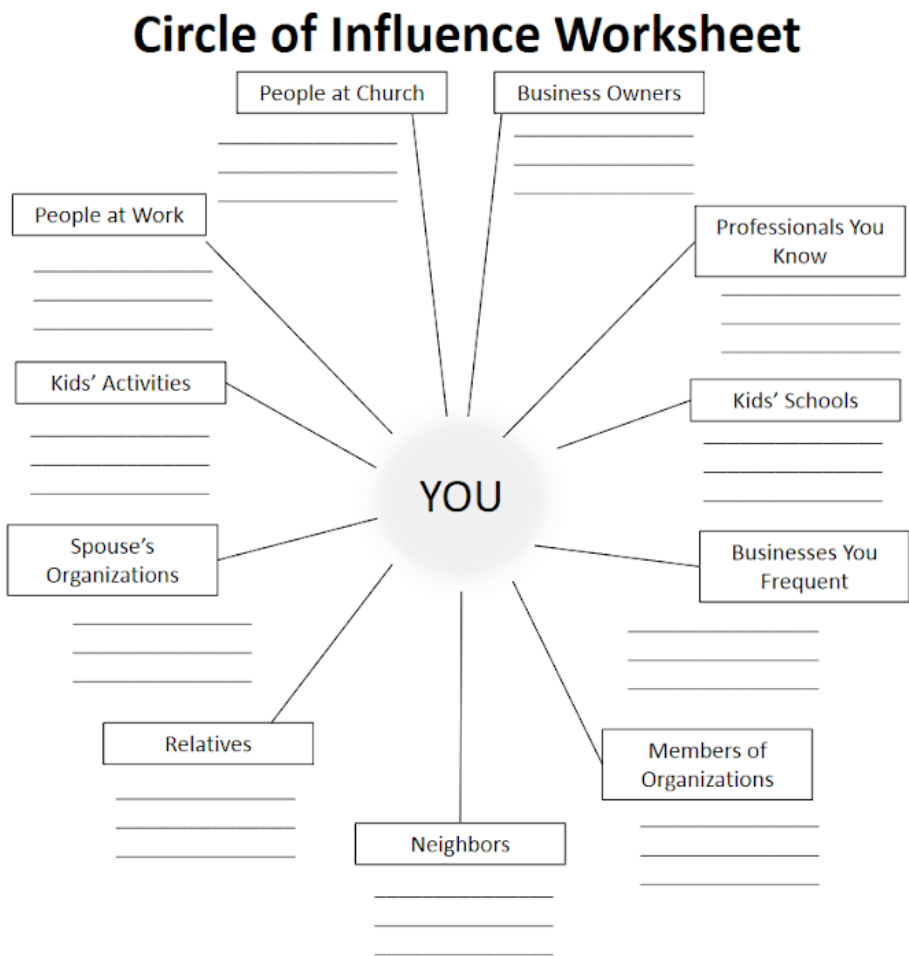
Every bank has fund set aside to invest in their community. This can come in the form of grants through their community reinvestment funds or as sponsorship of events and workshops. Either way, the best way to secure funding is to talk to someone at your bank to get information about where they are focusing their Community Reinvestment Funds.

A SCORE Mentor and Treasurer from Savannah diligently outlines his strategy for obtaining funds from one of the best sources of local financial support, banks. [Click here to view.](#)

Section 8: Your Circle of Influence

Think about all the people you know. You know more people than you think. What businesses do you patronize often? Who do you know that is passionate about small business? Passionate about helping people in underrepresented communities? Passionate about helping the community? What about coworkers? Or vendors you have worked with for years? Does your company donate for volunteer hours or have a matching gift program?

[Full worksheet available for download here.](#)



Your circle of influence is a great starting point for developing a list of potential donors. Have your chapter members use the worksheet provided above to generate a list of potential donors that the Fundraising Chair or Committee could connect with. The next section will outline how to make “the ask” to this list of potential donors.

Section 9: Building Towards the “Ask”

Your plan should aim to diversify sources of income, generate income over the whole year, and target donations based on the size and consistency of giving. Regardless of the giving level, a healthy fundraising program will have a diverse roster of donors that help fund specific projects or needs and unrestricted gifts for the daily administration of the office and programs.

“The key to getting donations is relationships - making them and keeping them.”

The key steps in asking for a donation include:

- Prepare & Research
- Preparing the “Ask” (Acquisition and Retention/Upgrading)
- Cultivation & Stewardship
- Recognition and Recap

Prepare & Research

- I. Create a target list by using the [Circle of Influence worksheet](#) in Section 8 and consider the following:
 - a. Who are we going to solicit?
 - b. Are they a credible organization? A leader in its class? Have a respected reputation?
 - c. Are they committed to serving small businesses and the community at large?
 - d. Do they have an alignment with the SCORE strategic goals and objectives?
 - e. Do they have the capacity and willingness to be financially supportive?
 - f. Would they be interested in a long-term relationship?
 - g. What is their mission? Vision? Core Values?
 - h. What are their funding priorities?
 - i. What is their giving potential?
 - j. What is their giving propensity to SCORE?
 - k. Where are the pockets of wealth in your community?

This is the advanced research phase of fundraising that lays the groundwork for all outreach. Be as specific in your answers as possible, and then make a list using the following sources as a starting point. Always start with whom you already know personally or professionally. A positive response from a friend or colleague is a great motivator!

To build a list:

- Make a list of the professionals you encounter daily such as doctors, merchants, bankers, and attorneys.
- Add the names of vendors who supply your chapter. Many vendors are willing to make donations to keep good customers happy.
- Make a list of people you know or are acquainted with who would likely give money.
- Ask each of your fundraising volunteers to make a list of 10 people they can ask for money.

- Ask each of your fundraising volunteers to make a list of Chapter members who have been financially supportive of SCORE – locally or nationally.
- Ask your local chamber of commerce for a list of the largest employers.
- Look at membership lists of private clubs or check the local society pages. See whose names appear relatively often as charitable donors.
- Check the local business pages to see which companies have stories written about their growth.

When you prepare your fundraising strategy, keep these things in mind. The more you know about the people in your community, the better relationship you can build with them, and the more likely you are to succeed in your fundraising goals.

- People give to people.
- People give to causes they believe in.
- People give to causes they believe in because of the people they respect who have asked them for the contribution.
- Also, people will give money to your chapter if you make it easy for them and show them how your chapter benefits their local community.

Preparing the “Ask”

Once you know whom you'll be asking, craft a message that each volunteer will use. This message will be the core of every request for money, and it can become the rallying point that motivates your fundraising volunteers.

Remember, what motivates people is local issues. Form your message accordingly and make sure that the message contains two parts.

Part 1: Why should a person give money to SCORE?

The first part of the message is easy - they should give money because SCORE helps strengthen and improve the community by

- educating small businesses and entrepreneurs
- helps the local economy by helping small businesses get established
- provides a free educational service that allows entrepreneurs and their businesses to grow and get stronger
- provides resources to help existing businesses get stronger in order to become more stable parts of the community

Strengthen these general examples with specific local examples of businesses helped, number of businesses counseled, number of volunteer hours given, etc.

Part 2: What does a person get out of the donation?

The second part of the message may be more complex because the benefit to the donor is not necessarily a direct benefit. But the entire community benefits by having successful businesses, and SCORE is responsible for helping to launch countless small businesses that succeed and contribute greatly to the local economy.

The next step in preparation is solicitation. By the time you get to this point, you are ready to ask for a donation, and people are often ready to consider a request. They know SCORE, they know you or a member of your organization, and you have helped them see themselves as involved in your efforts.

Lastly, you should follow-up. Equally crucial to soliciting support is following up to receive a final decision on your request. Prospective donors are often approached and solicited for gifts and then not followed up with to receive an answer. Do not leave the responsibility of bringing closure to your request with the prospective donor.

Sponsor Cultivation and Stewardship

It is time to reach out, tell your story and begin to build a relationship with prospective donors. First, identify methods to engage the donor in learning about your organization. Highlight your chapter's efforts to make a difference for people in the community and solidify the local economic base.

Before the Event:

- Get them involved: Keep that contact informed by sending updates when their sponsorship fulfillment is being implemented (for example: when their logo goes live on the website, event collateral is delivered, etc.). Are there ways the contact or other company staff can be more actively involved?
- Include the sponsor's name on all event materials alongside SCORE's.
- Determine a doable volunteer to sponsor ratio to manage the sponsor relationship. The goal is to provide a point of contact for each sponsor.
- Under promise and over-deliver: **Always** make sure you can deliver what you say you will.

During the Event:

- Recognize your sponsors at the event.
- Make sure they see and hear their name. Do everything you can to ensure that all types of recognition are delivered and that they can tell they are getting the exposure they paid for. Take pictures of logo placement whenever possible so that you can utilize them in the recap meeting post-event.

After the Event:

- Thank them often and in meaningful ways. Nobody ever complains about being thanked too much. Be creative in finding ways to recognize the sponsor and their leadership, depending on their contribution.

- Recapping - One of the most important customer service strategies you can utilize, is to thank your corporate sponsors and provide them with a full recap of their involvement in your event/program. Recapping should take place 1-2 months post-event to lay the groundwork for retention.
- Consider a special event to recognize all of your sponsors, such as a cocktail party or a holiday luncheon. If you have mentored an area restaurateur, all the better!
- Communicate year-round. Send cards, mission updates & call them periodically. Recognize them in your chapter collateral such as newsletters, bulletins, etc. Watch for ads, articles or business announcements in the local media. Cut them out and send it with a personal note. This will show you care about their success all year not just during your event/program.
- Make sure you ask for the next year. Find out their budget cycle and plan your meeting and ask around their budgeting process. Ask them if they would like to be a part of the fundraising committee.
- Always remember to thank your donor four (4) times before making an additional ask.

To initiate a successful request, here are some tips for obtaining and developing sponsor relationships:

- Send a well-crafted letter or make a phone call and ask for a meeting to discuss their objectives and ideas on local small businesses.
- Spend the time on initial 2-3 meetings to learn as much as possible about their needs.
- Make your request in person, when applicable.
- Ask for a specific amount for a donor to be an event sponsor.
- Confirm the meeting in writing (i.e., email, letter, etc.)
- Describe the sponsor benefits to the donor. Be specific.

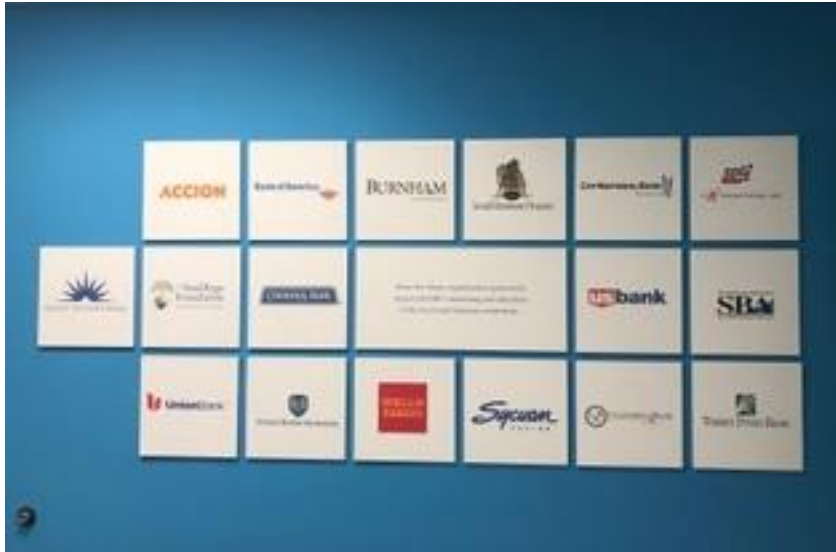
Recognition and Recap

Relationships with donors must be developed and sustained over time, not just when you want to ask for a donation. Commit to regularly keeping in contact with your donors and always remember the lasting impact of a personal "thank you." The rule of thumb? Thank the donor often throughout the year – at least four times! The donor should feel sufficiently appreciated and have a positive, lasting impression of SCORE. Each contact is an opportunity to develop the relationship and reinforce the commitment to SCORE. A sample Thank You letter is provided in [Section 3: Tools and Resource Directory](#).

You can and should do some or all of the following:

- Call immediately after the gift is received.
- Send a proper acknowledgment letter (ideally 24-48 hours after the gift is received) with the proper receipt.
- List them in the annual report or newsletter and send it to them when it's published with a second thank you note.
- Invite them to a free-fee good event such as lunch with a key volunteer or a Small Business Week luncheon.

- Send a Thanksgiving or holiday card.
- Send an e-mail letter telling them of recent success or award.
- Treat donors as lifelong friends. Treat them with respect, get to know them, and recognize their genuine commitment to your work.



This picture is the donor recognition wall at the SCORE San Diego offices.

Section 10: Your Fundraising Plan

Be prepared to plan for many years of fundraising. The goal is to create a culture of philanthropy for your local SCORE chapter, and to do so will require you to develop “a habit of giving.” People often need to be asked more than once before they give. And once they begin to give, they need to be thanked, informed, shown stewardship for their gift, and then asked again in the future.

The first year of any fundraising campaign tends to be a learning year. You will probably find that, as your fundraisers learn from their mistakes and refine fundraising campaigns, your donation level will increase. You will also learn what approach works best for your different target audiences and be able to concentrate your efforts more effectively.

SCORE Chapter Fundraising Checklist

- ☒ Review chapter business plan to identify needs to be funded
- ☒ Develop a budget for needs to be funded/resources available
 - Review projected timing for each identified need
 - Review income by source

- Review income by type
- ☒ Develop a projection of income based upon the past year(s)
- ☒ Review current methods of meeting past needs
- ☒ Review volunteer resources for raising funds
- ☒ Develop the plan of activities and volunteers responsible to meet the fundraising goals
- ☒ Evaluate the results and repeat the process annually

Chapter Resources and Program Checklist

Does my chapter have the following volunteer resources?

- ☒ Fundraising Chair or person responsible for leading chapter fundraising
- ☒ Fundraising Committee or team responsible for leading chapter fundraising

Which of the following programs will the chapter use to fundraise?

- ☒ Workshop Sponsorships
- ☒ Website Sponsorships
- ☒ Newsletter Sponsorships
- ☒ Other Sponsorships
- ☒ Donations from Chapter
- ☒ SCORE Tribute Program
- ☒ Members to the chapter
- ☒ Local/State Government Grants
- ☒ Private/Other grants
- ☒ Special events (luncheon/golf outing/awards dinner/advisory board/business expo, etc)

5 Step Fundraising Plan

STEP 1

Align your fundraising goals with your chapter's business plan. Typically, donors of all types will want to know why you need the funds and what you expect to do with the funds, by when and how. Think of your business plan as the vehicle for getting to your destination and the funding as the fuel.

If you do not have a business plan, it is very important that you take the time to complete one. Understanding what your chapter's needs are and the cost to meet those needs will assist you in growing and evaluating your overall efforts.

STEP 2

Once you have established the priorities through the strategic business plan, and then define the methods of how you will achieve the priorities. Methods help you determine outcomes, which you report to funders.

STEP 3

Time to budget. Realistically examine the amount of money that you will need to fulfill each element of your business plan.

STEP 4

Income Analysis: Where does the money come from? Break down your revenue or income by source or gift type.

By Source:

- Individuals (direct member or client contributions, tribute gifts, etc....)
- Corporations (workshop sponsorships, other corporate gifts)
- Foundations (grants)
- Local or State Government
- Other agencies/organizations (e.g., Chamber of Commerce)
- Fee for service (workshops)
- Sales of resource materials

By Gift Type:

- Cash
- Pledges
- In-Kind

STEP 5

It is ideal if you can project a year ahead and begin raising money now for projects that will not require resources until the next year. This forward-funding perspective helps keep the chapter fiscally healthy and ensures that you are only doing those things which are funded and thus can be completed successfully.

Complete an Income Projection:

- How much do you need to raise this year to support the projects in the strategic plan for next year?
- What can you expect to raise from current sources next year?
- Project income based on the previous year. If this is the first year of your fundraising effort, contact the SCORE Association National Office for information on how similar size and type SCORE offices are performing.
- Use the projection matrixes by source or by gift type below to project your revenue.

Revenue Projection Matrix by Source

Source of Funds	Actual Revenue Last FY	Projected Revenue This FY	Required Revenue Next FY	Projected Revenue Next FY
Corporations				
Foundations				
Local/State Government				
Individuals				
Other Organizations				
Total				

Revenue Projection Matrix by Gift Type

Gifts by Type	Actual Revenue Last FY	Projected Revenue This FY	Required Revenue Next FY	Projected Revenue Next FY
Annual unrestricted gifts from individuals				
Program sponsorship (workshops, newsletters, website)				
Event sponsorships (awards dinners, luncheons, golf outings, etc.)				
Event proceeds (tickets; non-sponsorships)				
Total				

